



# Macro-level interoperability in e-health

Janek Metsallik, E-Health Architect  
School of IT, Department of Healthcare Technology  
Tallinn University of Technology



Digital Health Architect, PhD researcher, lecturer, supervisor

Tallinn University of Technology - TalTech

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/janekmetsallik>

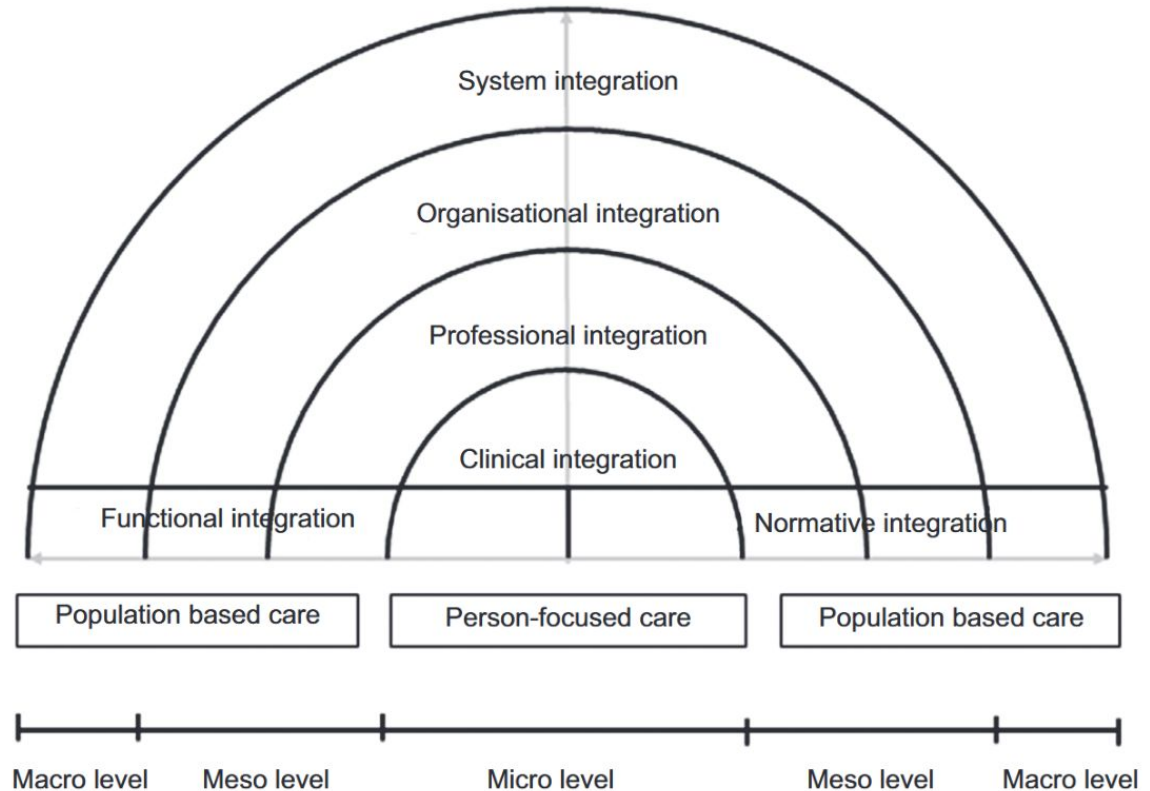
[https://www.etis.ee/CV/Janek\\_Metsallik/eng/  
janek.metsallik@taltech.ee](https://www.etis.ee/CV/Janek_Metsallik/eng/janek.metsallik@taltech.ee)

- 2024 - Digital Health Architect. Healthcare digitalization program, Uzbekistan
- 2023 - 2024 Digital Health Architect. National Health Data Analytics, Romania
- 2021 - 2023 E-health expert. Next Gen National EHR capabilities. Estonia
- 2019 Digital Health Architect. National Health Data Analytics, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia
- 2018 - 2019 Digital Health Architect. E-Health Architecture, MoH of Ukraine
- 2017 - 2020 Enterprise Architect. Health Sector Architecture, MoH of Mongolia
- 2016 Digital Health Architect. ITU Digital Health Acceleration Kit
- 2015 E-health Expert. Feasibility Study for Personalised Medicine in Estonia
- 2014 – 2018 Solution Architecture, Direct Access Laboratory Portal
- 2013 – 2014 Solution Architecture, X-Road pilot in Finland
- 2006 – 2011 Solution Architecture, Estonian National Health Records
- 1996 – 1999 Solution Architecture, Estonian Revenue Information System

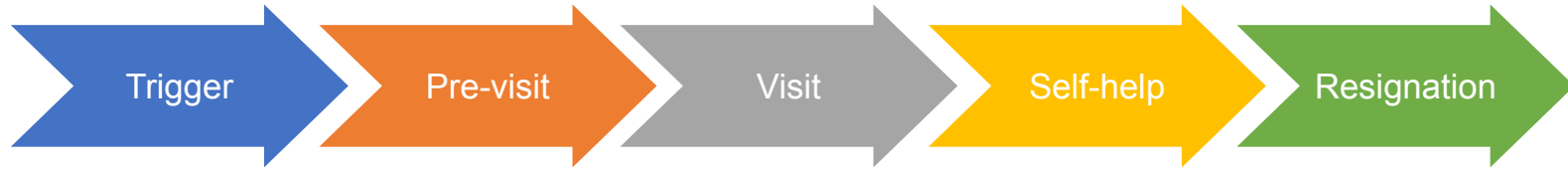
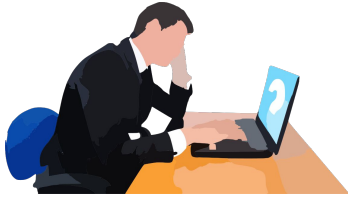
# Integrated care

Integrated care is a complex social process influenced by macro-level circumstances such as legislative mandates, meso-level features such as organizational leadership, and micro-level interactions between health/social care providers and patients.

J. A. Shaw, P. Kontos, W. Martin, ja C. Victor, „The institutional logic of integrated care: an ethnography of patient transitions“, Journal of Health Organization and Management, kd 31, nr 1, lk 82–95, märts 2017, doi: 10.1108/JHOM-06-2016-0123



# Martin discovers a need for personal prevention



Martin reads a story about men's health from the newspaper. The story describes various health concerns that men of his age may face. Martin decides to look into possible preventive activities.

The family doctor's assistant asked Martin to fill out a personal health declaration before the doctor's appointment. Martin filled out the health declaration via the patient portal.

During the appointment, the family doctor looked at Martin's medical history and asked additional questions about his lifestyle. The family doctor found no reason to refer Martin for further examination.

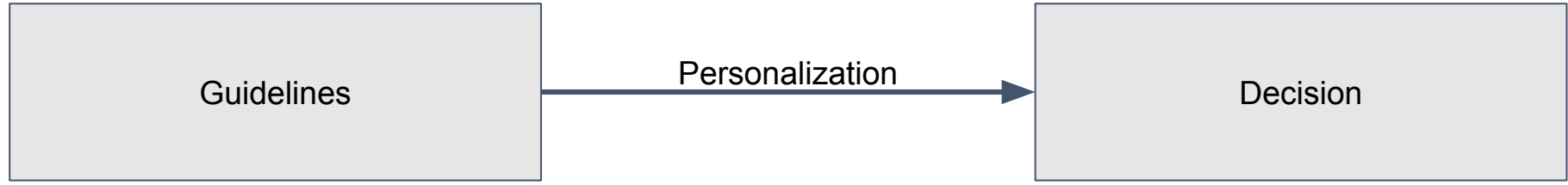
Martin searched the web for healthcare services. A rich selection of laboratory tests along with nutritional counseling was offered in one location. The second site offered a variety of stress tests along with a personal training plan. Martin was not sure if the services would fit his personal prevention plan.

Since Martin didn't have more time to think about his personal prevention plan at the moment, he postponed the decision for the future.

## Martin's moments of decision-making

- Do I need to make a personal health prevention plan now?
- Do I need to visit my GP for my personal prevention plan?
- Do I need to fill in a health declaration before the doctor's appointment?
- Should I declare having a good sleep, being a non-smoker, and having an active lifestyle?
- Do I need other healthcare services for my personal prevention planning?
- Does a web search result include useful references for my personal prevention plan?
- Do I need a lab test with a nutrition advisory for my personal prevention?
- Do I need a load test with a personal training advisory for my personal prevention?
- Can I postpone the personal prevention planning until I have more time?

## Martin decides to have his health status reviewed

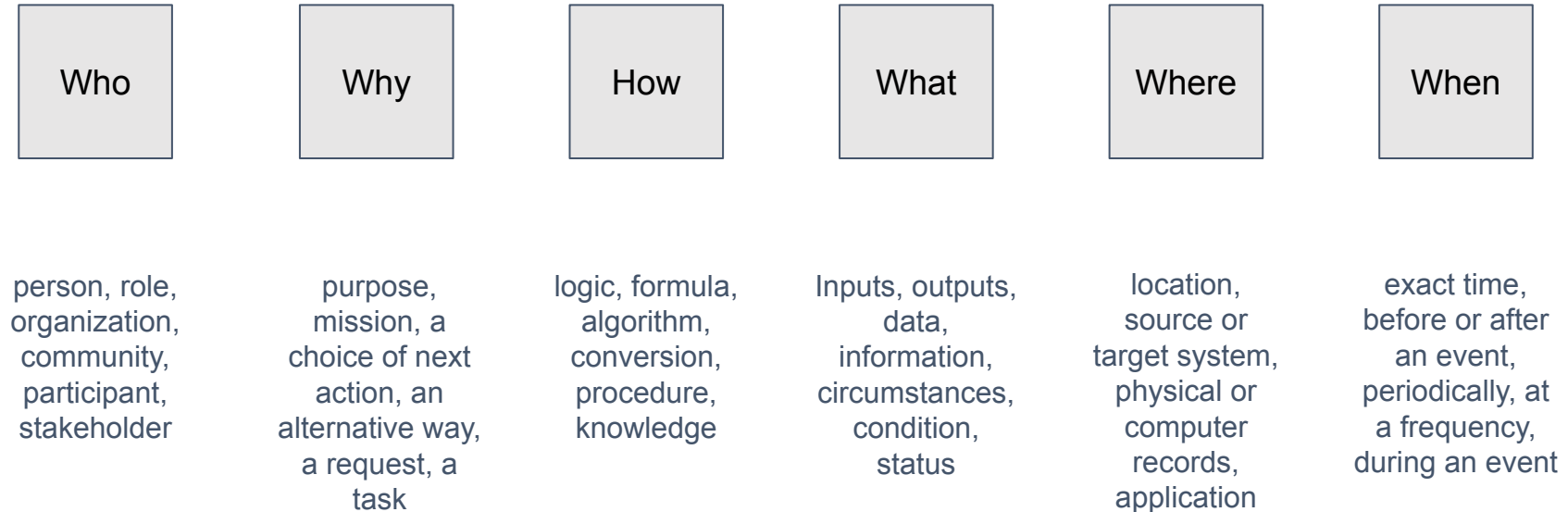


men over 45, with an above normal body mass index, having history of heart issues in their family may need to have their health status reviewed and to consider revision of their lifestyle.

Name: Martin  
Sex: male  
Age: 51  
Body weight: 94 kg  
Body height: 182 cm  
Family history: infarction  
Medical history: outdated

Martin needs to have his health status reviewed

# Analysis framework for the elements of decision-making (Zachman)



## Elements of Martin's decision to look into his health prevention

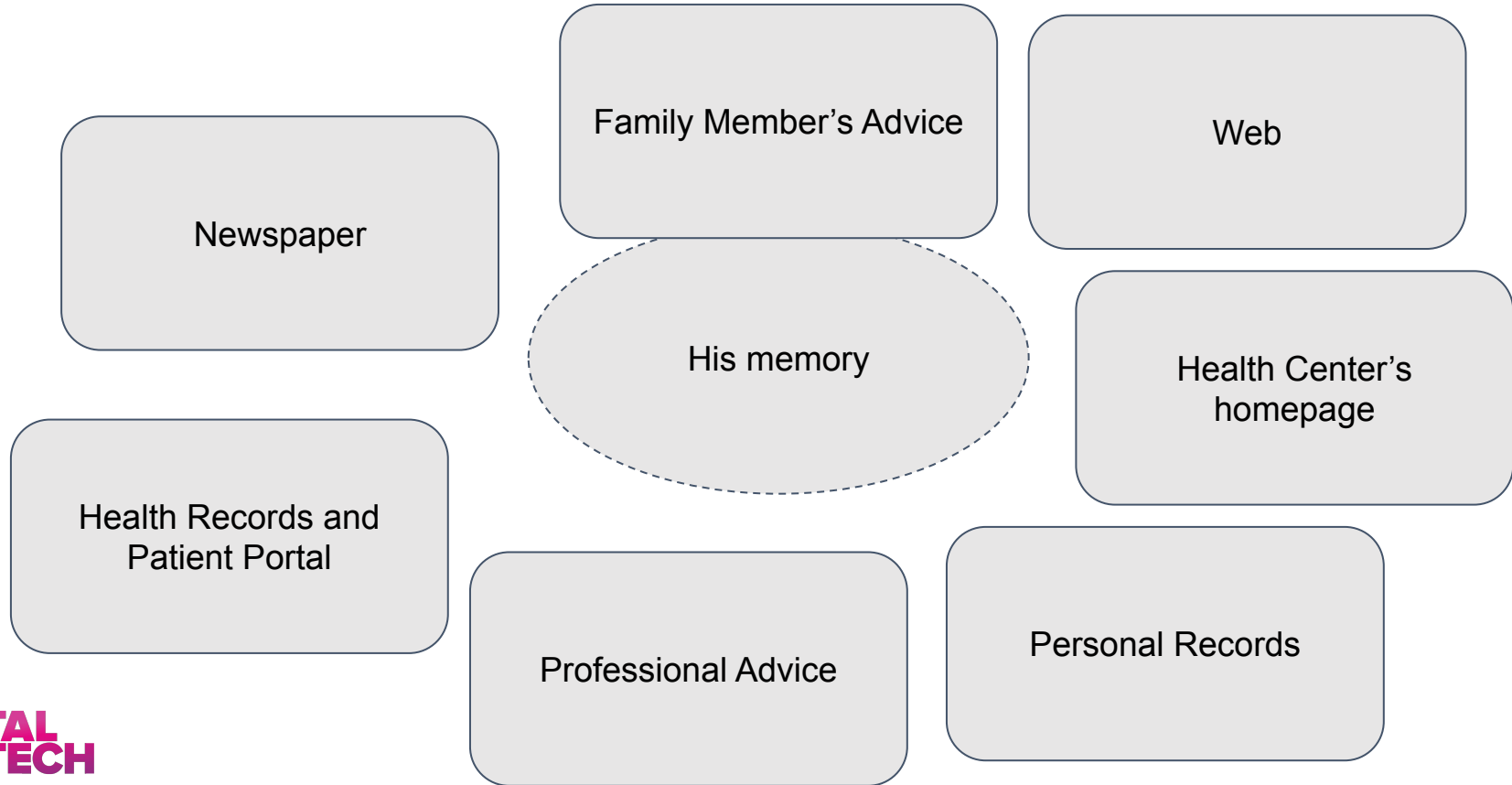
- **Why:** to find out if the guideline from the newspaper matches his profile and decide about the personal prevention plan
- **How:** the guideline suggests that men over 45, with an above normal body mass index, having history of heart issues in their family may need to have their health status reviewed and to consider revision of their lifestyle.
- **Who:** home user / visitor / patient
- **What:** age, sex, body weight, body height, family history, medical records, and health goals.
- **Where:** personal memory, family member, patient portal.
- **When:** campaign in the news



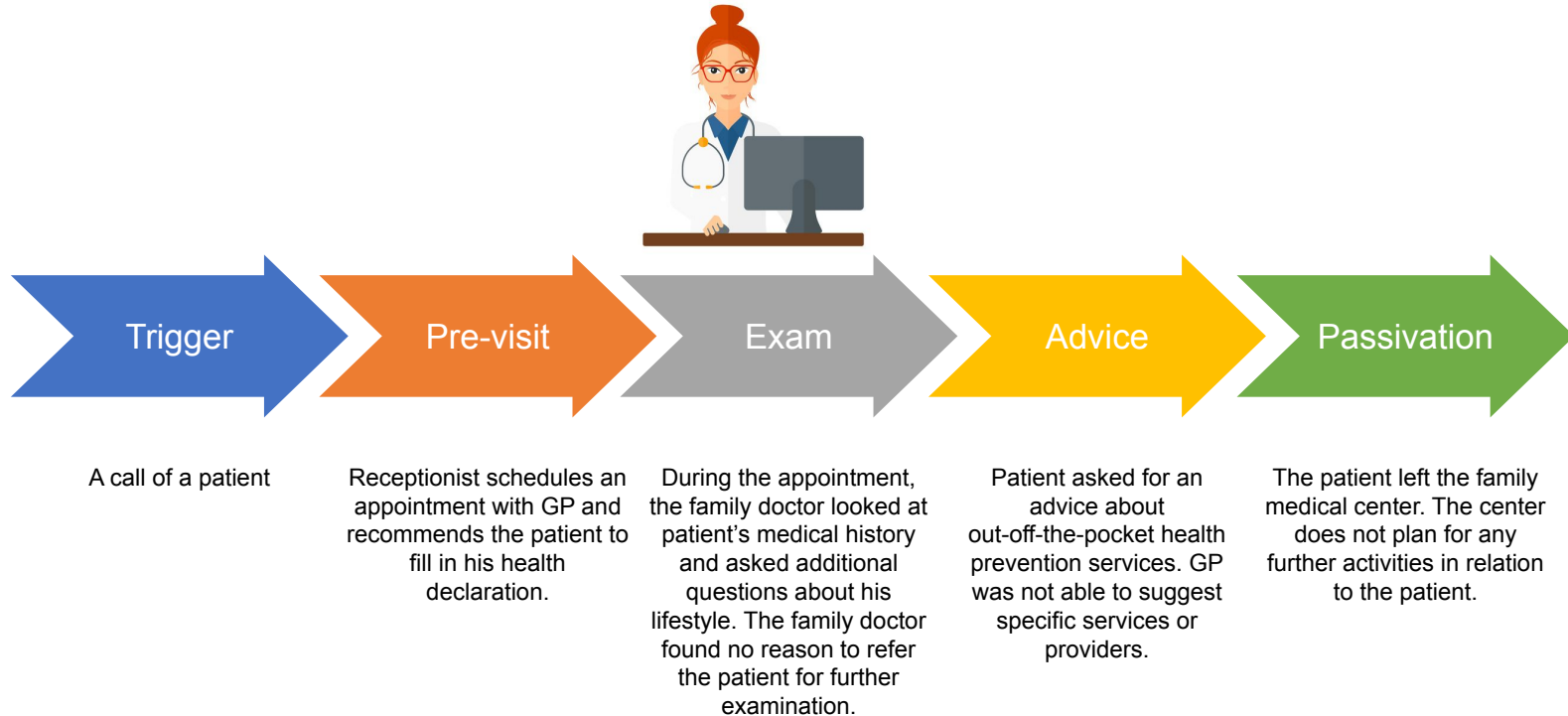
# Information used for decision-making

| Decision (Why)                                                                            | Information (What)                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Do I need to make a personal health prevention plan now?                                  | Age, sex, body weight, body height, family history, health records, lifestyle, and health goals |
| Do I need to visit my GP for my personal prevention plan?                                 | habits, community advice                                                                        |
| Do I need to fill in a health declaration before the doctor's appointment?                | request by the receptionist                                                                     |
| Should I declare having a good sleep, being a non-smoker, and having an active lifestyle? | personal observations according to his memory                                                   |
| Do I need other healthcare services for my personal prevention planning?                  | health concerns, health goals, health check summary document by GP                              |
| Does a web search result include useful references for my personal prevention plan?       | web search results, personal assessment                                                         |
| Do I need a lab test with a nutrition advisory for my personal prevention?                | health concerns, health goals                                                                   |
|                                                                                           |                                                                                                 |

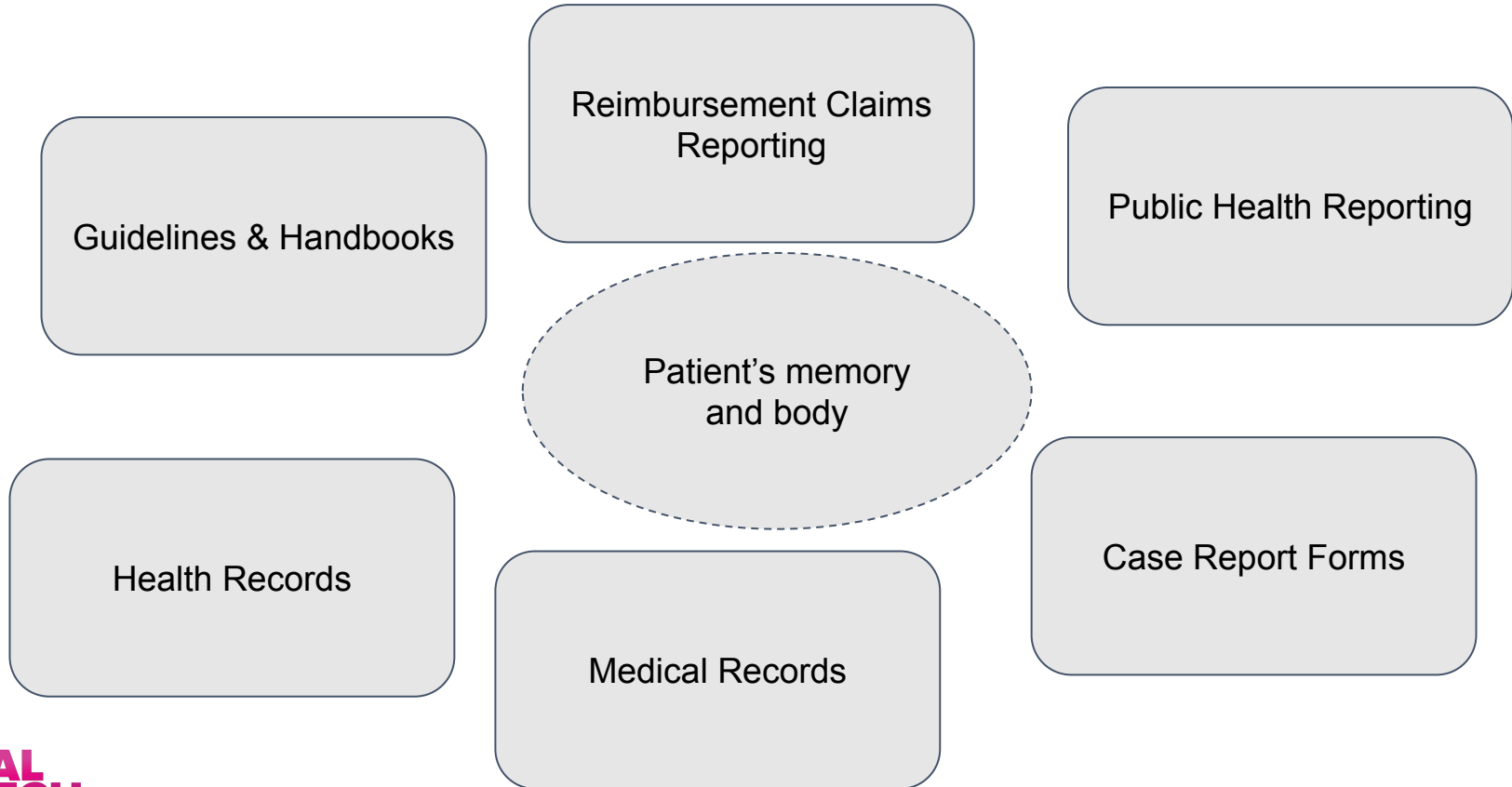
## Martin's systems of health information



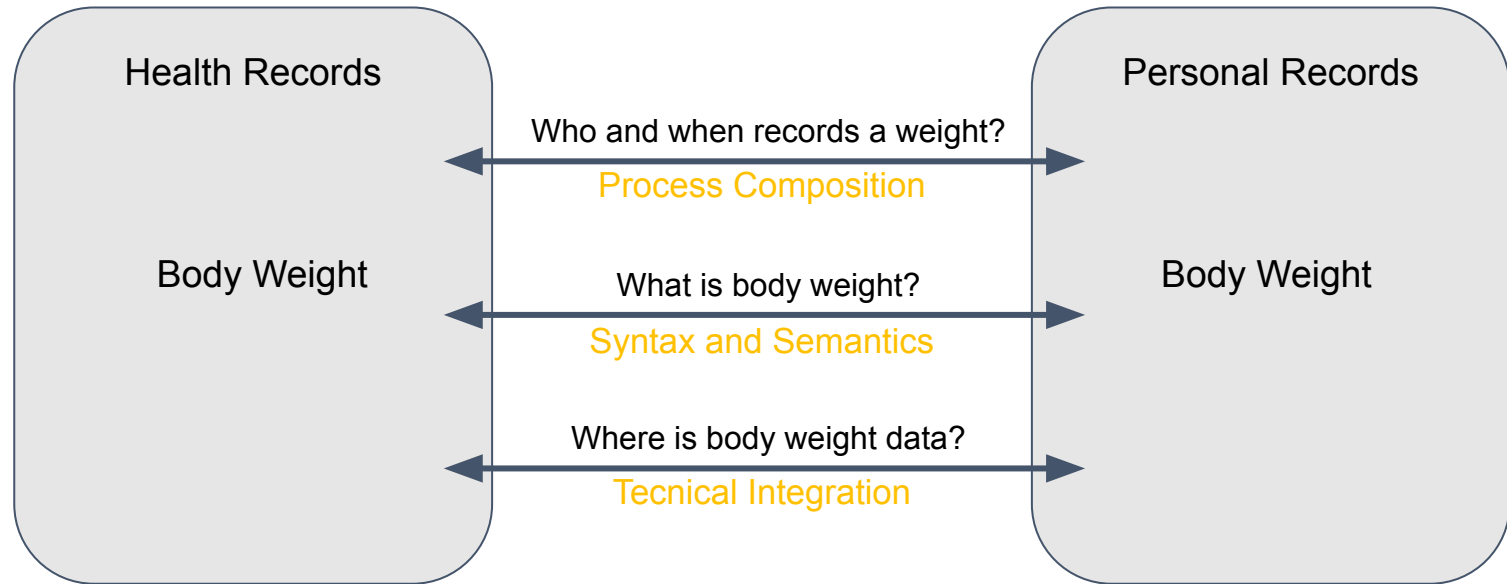
# GP conducts a health checkup for personal prevention



## GP's systems of health information



# Can Martin share his personal records with a physician?



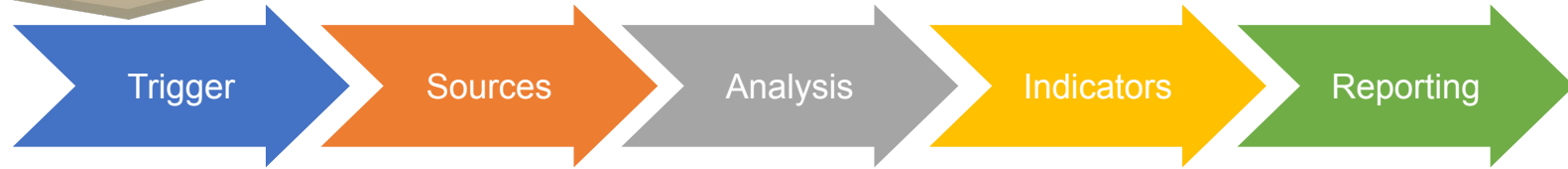
[1] A. Tolk, „Levels of Conceptual Interoperability“, 2003 Fall Simulation Interoperability Workshop.

[2] A. Tolk, L. J. Bair, ja S. Y. Diallo, „Supporting Network Enabled Capability by extending the Levels of Conceptual Interoperability Model to an interoperability maturity model“, Journal of Defense Modeling & Simulation, kd 10, nr 2, lk 145–160, apr 2013, doi: 10.1177/1548512911428457.

## Interoperability of the health data

- **Technical Integration** - the sources of information are connected into a computer network and securely share data - data in the right location
  - Martin approaches all the sources separately and maintains their integrity manually
- **Syntax and Semantics** - the data is linked to shared terminologies and master data - data - data content fits the decision-algorithms
  - Martin's personal identifier, body weight, age, and sex have common meaning for both personal and health records
  - Martin's family history, lifestyle data, and health goals are unstructured data, which need human interpretation always
- **Process Composability** - the flow of data satisfies the needs of downstream decision-making - data is timely and actionable
  - Martin needs to recapture his family health history. Most probably his smoking status needs recapture for public health research.

# A public health researcher monitors health risks of



Public health monitoring plan, extraordinary study of risk factors

The researcher considered the national health information system, the information systems of hospitals and family doctors, medical claims, interviewing people, clinical research, and disease registries as data sources.

For both studies, it was necessary to know the smoking habits; for the cardio risk factor study, it was also important to know the heart disease diagnoses of the respective people.

Indicators on the consumption of alcohol and tobacco products were part of the routine monitoring. In addition to the monitoring plan, the institute also planned an extraordinary study of risk factors for cardiovascular diseases.

annual public health monitoring, extraordinary study of risk factors

# WHO List of 100 Core Health Indicators

- **Health status** indicators include core indicators including mortality by age, sex and cause (that includes the 16 mortality related indicators of the health and health related SDGs as well as core morbidity and fertility indicators).
- **Risk factors** indicators include those relating to nutrition, environmental, behavioural, injuries and violence.
- **Service coverage** indicators reflect priorities across the spectrum of health services including reproductive, maternal, newborn, child and adolescent, immunization, HIV, TB, malaria, neglected tropical diseases, noncommunicable diseases, mental health and substance abuse.
- **Health systems** indicators include indicators of health system inputs and outputs such as health facility density and distribution, health workforce, health information and quality and safety of care, health security capacity.

“Global Reference List of 100 Core Health Indicators,” SCORE for health data. Accessed: Jul. 20, 2021. [Online]. Available:

<https://score.tools.who.int/tools/enable-data-use-for-policy-and-action/tool/global-reference-list-of-100-core-health-indicators-72/>



# Tobacco use among persons aged 15+ years [SDG 3.a.1]

**Definition:** Age-standardized prevalence of current tobacco use among persons aged 15+ years.

“Smoked tobacco products” includes cigarettes, cigarillos, cigars, cheroots, bidis, pipes, shisha (water pipes), roll-your-own tobacco, kreket, and any other form of tobacco that is consumed by smoking.

“Smokeless tobacco” includes moist snuff, plug, creamy snuff, dry snuff, plug, dissolvables, gul, loose leaf, red tooth powder, snus, chimo, gutkha, khaini, gudakhu, zarda, quiwam, dohra, tuibur, nasway, naas/naswar, shammah, betel quid, toombak, pan (betel quid), iq’mik, mishri, tapkeer, tombol and any other tobacco product that is consumed by sniffing, holding in the mouth, or chewing.

“Current use” means use at the time of the survey, whether daily use or occasional use.

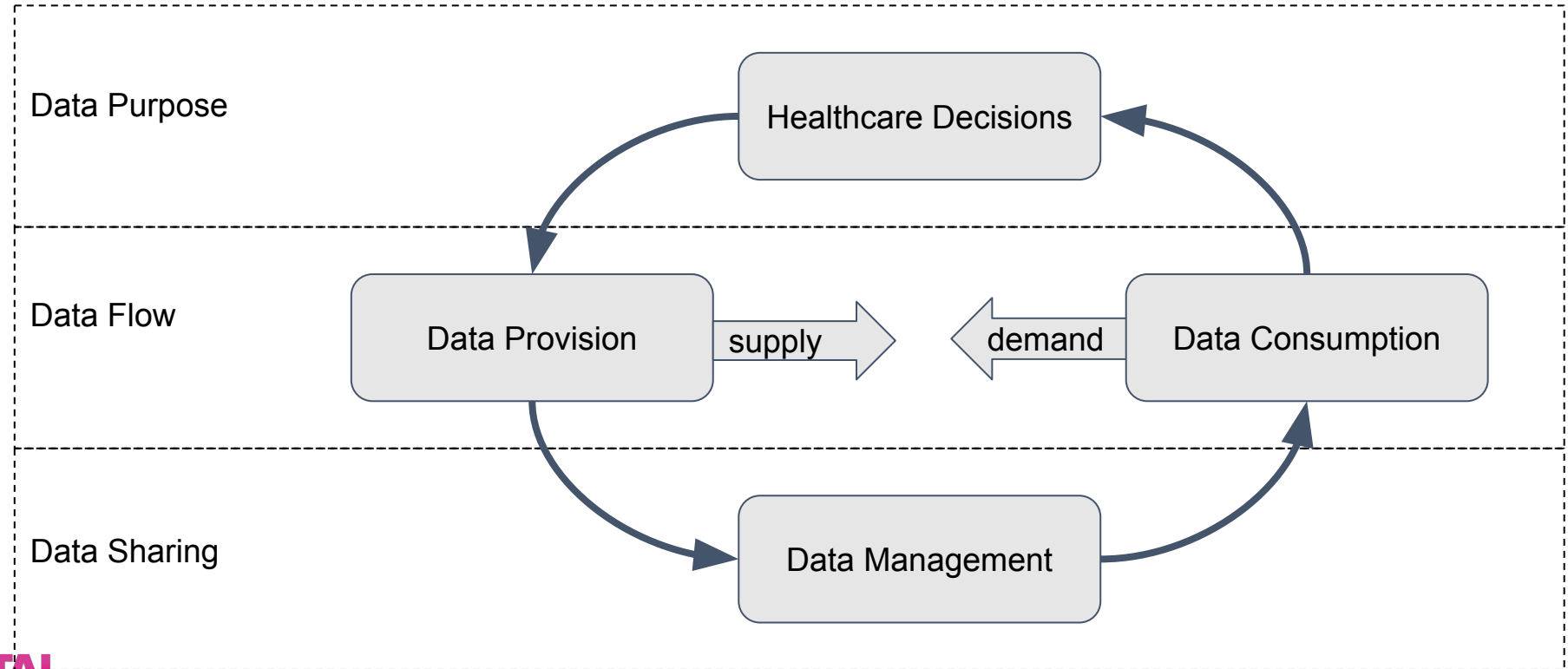
**Numerator:** Number of current tobacco users aged 15+ years.

**Denominator:** Total population aged 15+ years.

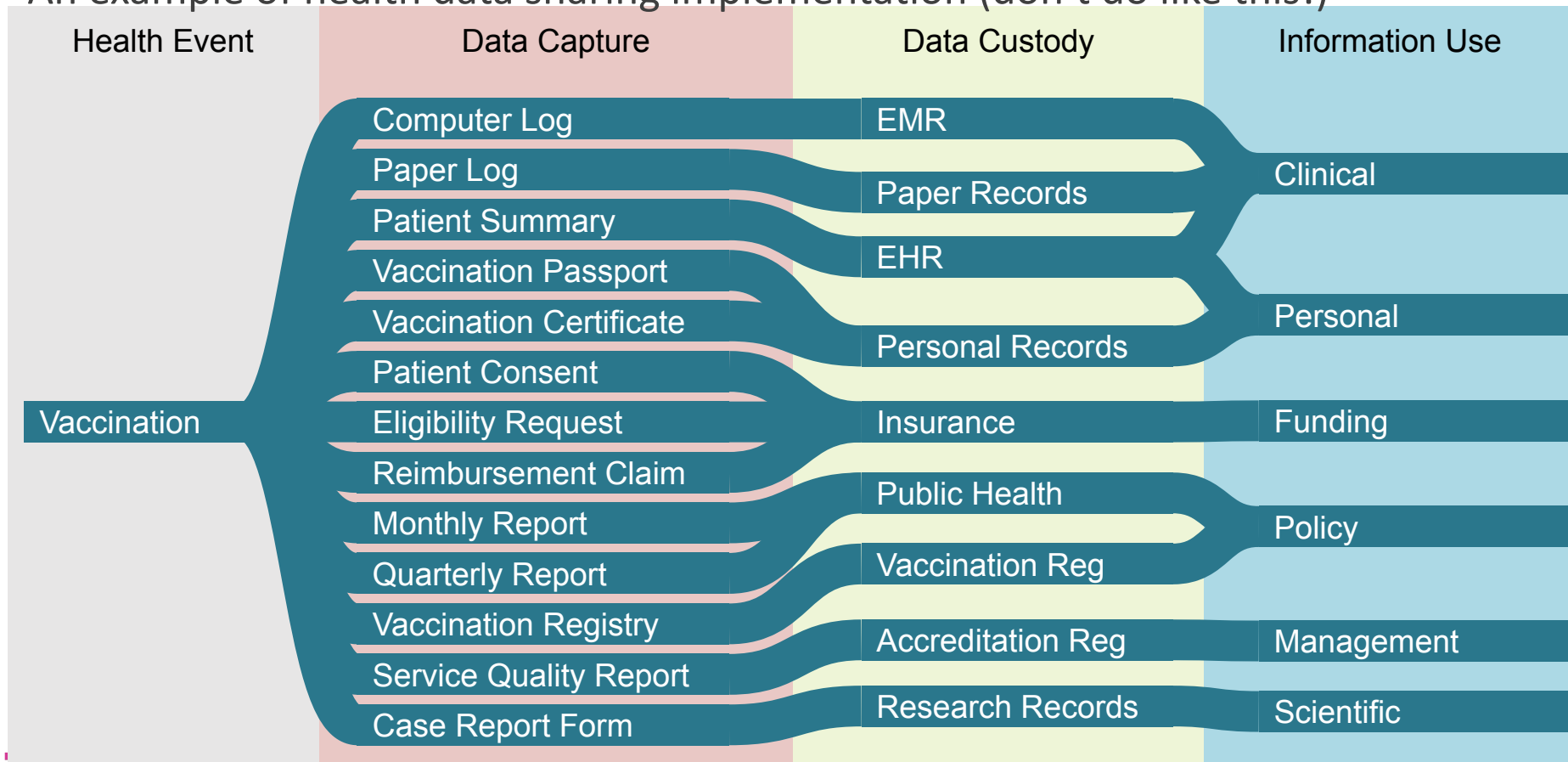
**Disaggregation:** additional dimension: Age, sex

**Method:** 
$$\frac{\text{Number of respondents aged 15+ years currently using any tobacco product (smoked or smokeless)}}{\text{(number of survey respondents aged 15+ years)}} \times 100.$$

## Tensions between supply and demand make data flow



# An example of health data sharing implementation (don't do like this!)



## services

Type of Act: decree

Valid to:      in force

<https://www.riigiteataja.ee/akt/117082021010>

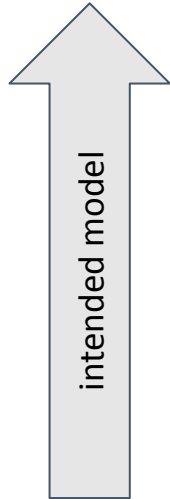
| IMMUNISEERIMISED |             |         |              |               |
|------------------|-------------|---------|--------------|---------------|
| ajakava          |             | kuupäev | seeria, doos | allkiri, kood |
| vanus            | vaktsiin    |         |              |               |
| 3-5 päeva        | BCG 1       |         |              |               |
| 3 kuud           | PDT 1+OPV 1 |         |              |               |
| 4,5 kuud         | PDT 2+OPV 2 |         |              |               |
| 6 kuud           | PDT 3+OPV 3 |         |              |               |
| 1 aasta          | MMR 1       |         |              |               |
| 2 aastat         | PDT 4+OPV 4 |         |              |               |
| 7 aastat         | dT 5+OPV 5  |         |              |               |
| 8 aastat         | BCG 2       |         |              |               |
| 12 aastat        | dT 6        |         |              |               |
| 13 aastat        | MMR 2       |         |              |               |
| 17 aastat        | dT 7        |         |              |               |
|                  |             |         |              |               |
|                  |             |         |              |               |

[illegible]

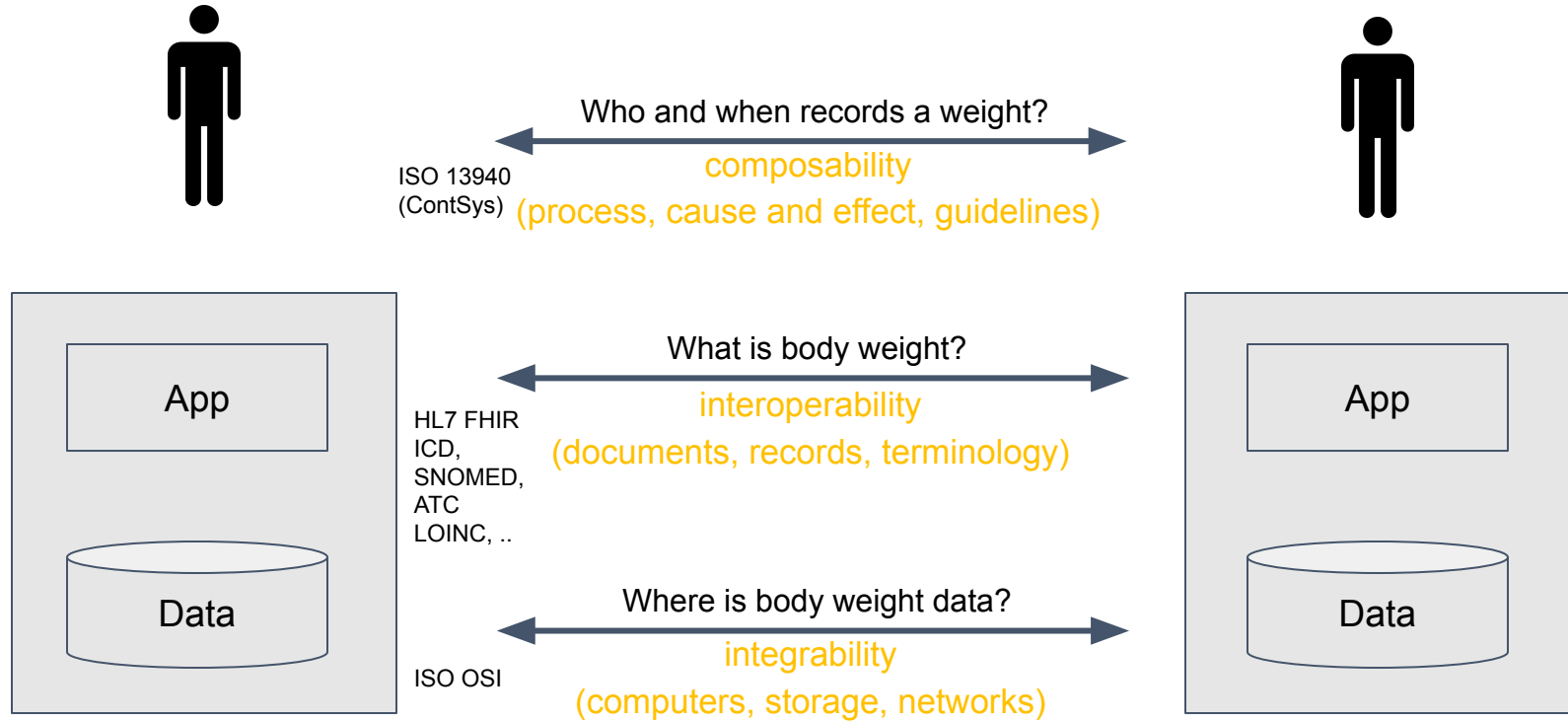
## Körvaltoimet

# Logic of Data Sharing

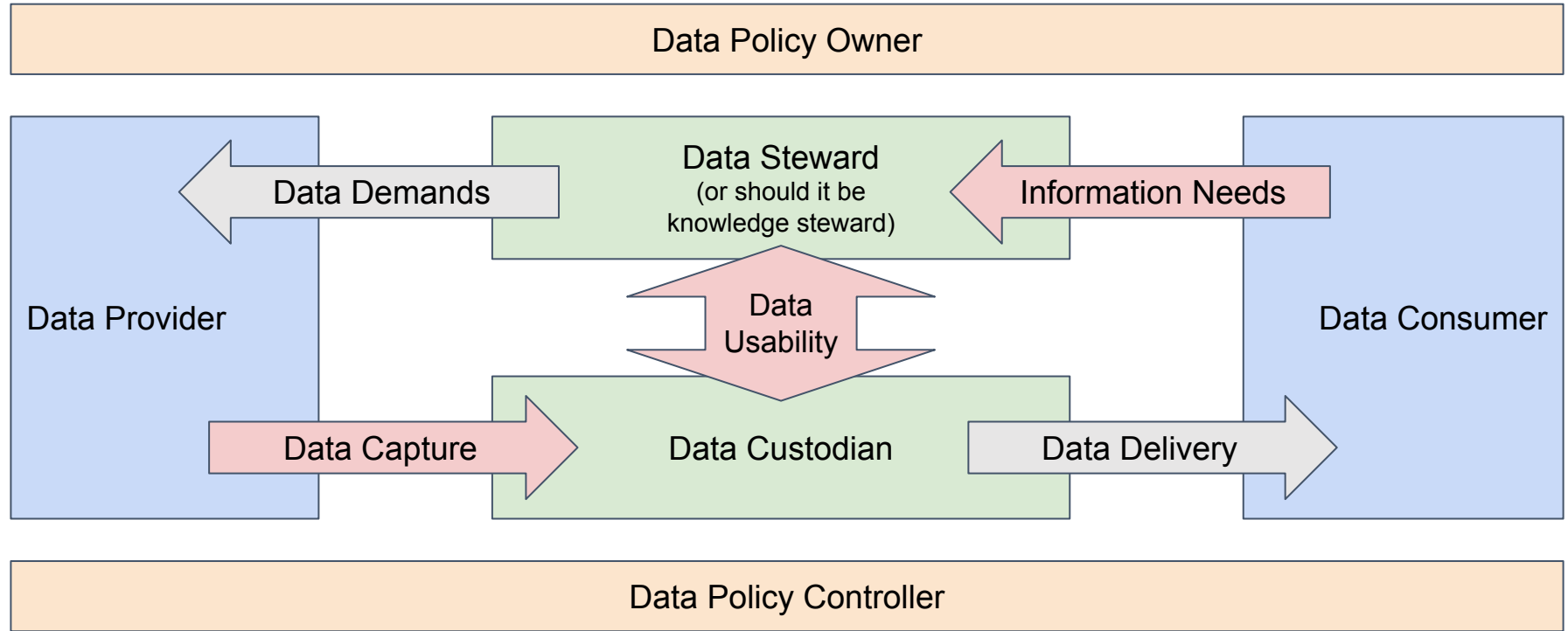
|                                           | Governance                             | Ecosystem agility | Data use for multipurpose | Data Standards |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------|----------------|
| Informational<br>(vision/<br>expectation) | Diverse<br>(confederat.,<br>matrix)    | High              | Fundamental               | Dynamic        |
| Shared<br>registries<br>(state-of-art)    | Monopoly,<br>Fragmented,<br>Federative | Low               | Static                    | Central        |
| Transactional<br>(common)                 | Bilateral,<br>Multilateral             | Moderate          | Secondary                 | Contractual    |



# Levels of interoperability



# Governance concepts of data sharing



## Ambulance guidelines

## Secondary usage requirements

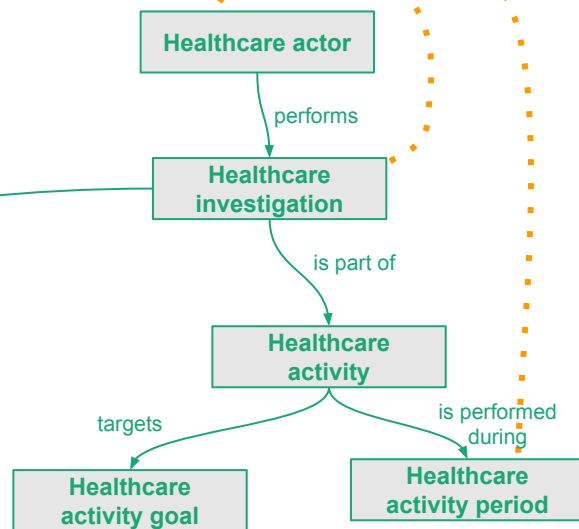
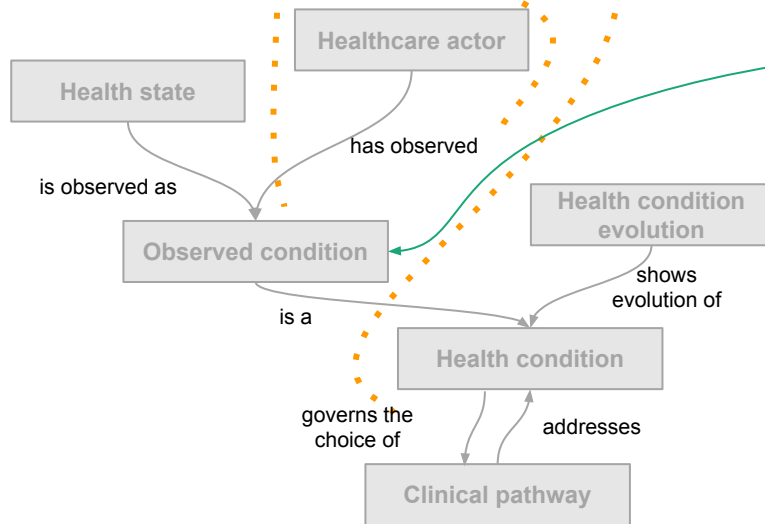
Narrative

*"when blood pressure < 100 mmHg"*

*"We need to know who, when and why"*

Needs

Concepts  
(ContSys)





# Health data policy shall empower pervasive data stewardship

**Policy:** data sharing regulations shall be harmonized against an explicit ontology (contsys)

**Impact:** Selection and Adaptation of a Concept System - Contsys ISO 13940 has been translated

**Impact:** Establishing the principle and responsibility of ontological compatibility of data requirements

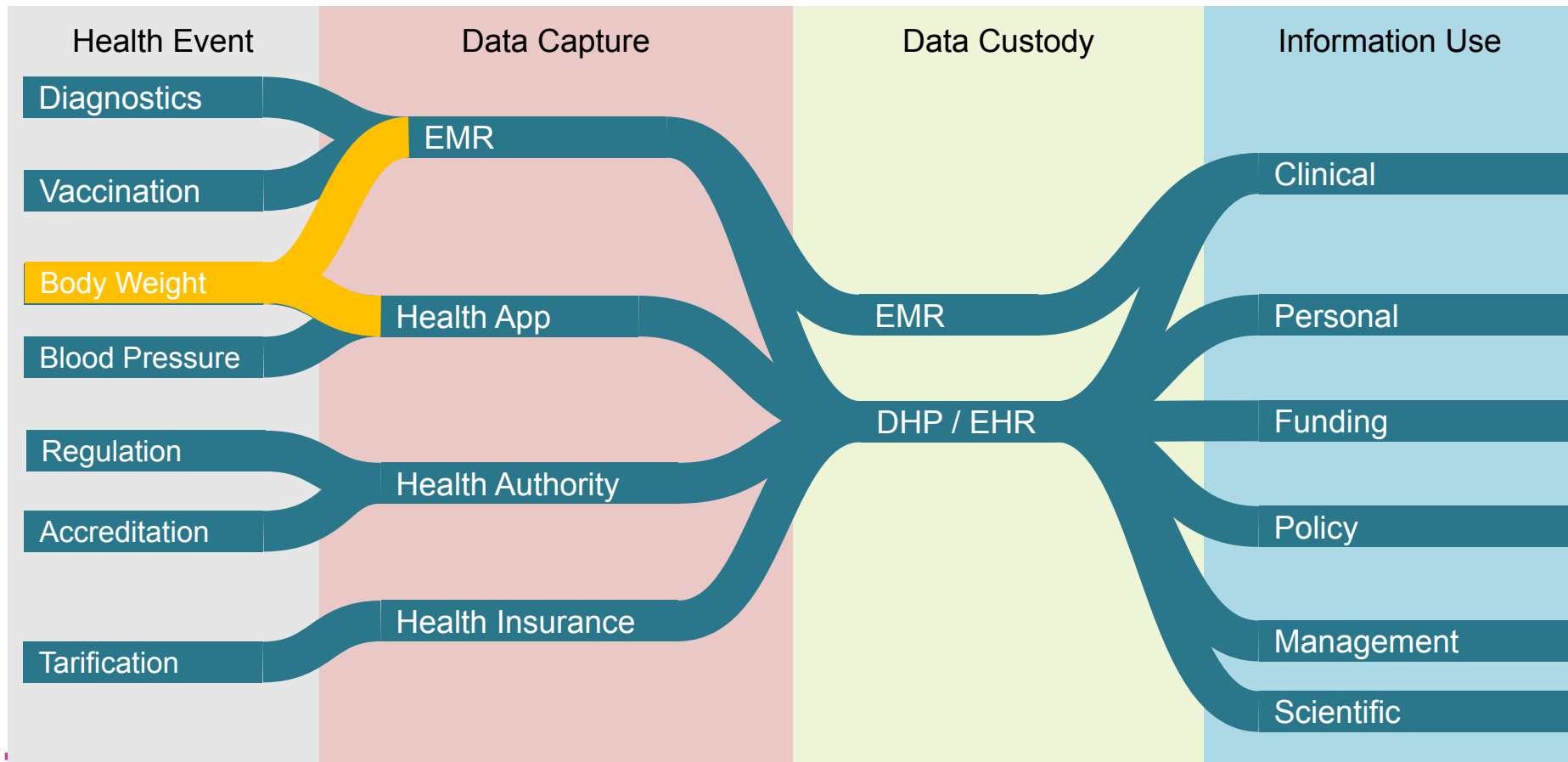
**Impact:** Creation of a comprehensive management environment for data requirements

**Impact:** Creation of a tool for systematic validation of data requirements (ontological compatibility)

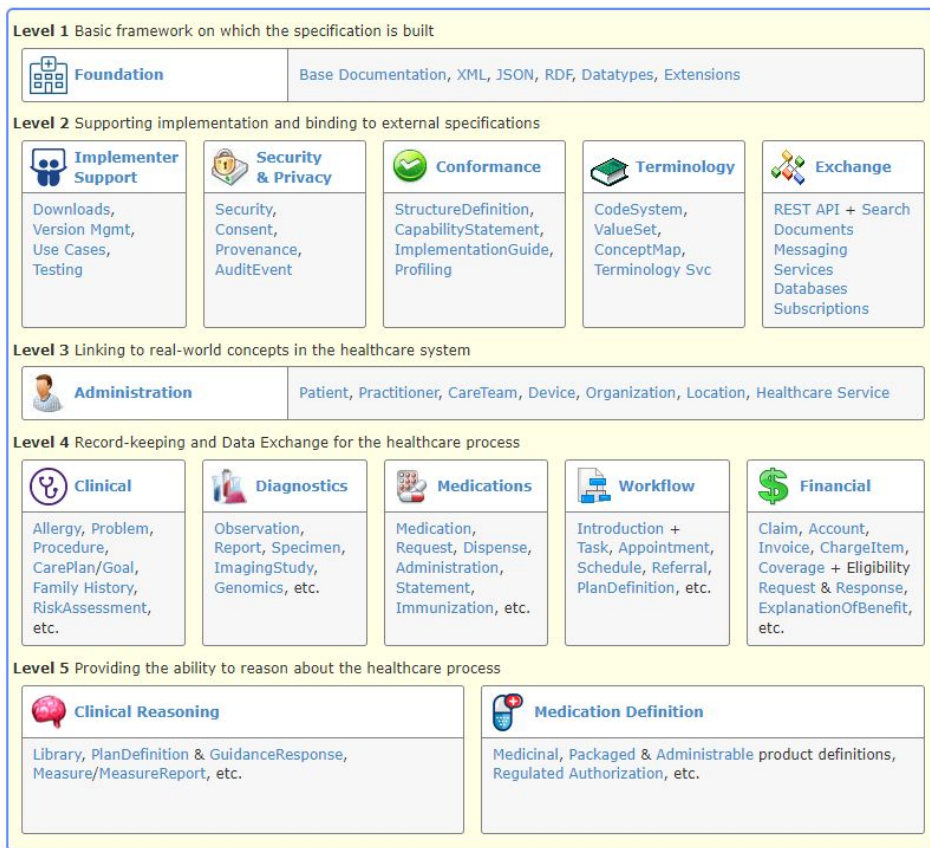
**Impact:** Linking data needs, information models, terminologies and message templates to validated requirements - work process and tool

**Rationale:** the continuity of health care processes (including the treatment process) is based on effective digitalization, the prerequisite for effective digitalization is multiple use of data, the prerequisite for multiple use of data is a compatible system of concepts

# A vision of an ideal way of sharing data for multiple use (COUMT)



# HL7 FHIR Levels



Level 1 - technologies for encoding data into **digital formats**; data types and base structures for utilizing computer networks

Level 2 - rules and structures for coding **metadata**; data that specifies security, conformance, terminology, and exchange features of a health data space

Level 3 - rules and structures for **master data** management; data that enables linking of records to people, organizations, devices, locations and services

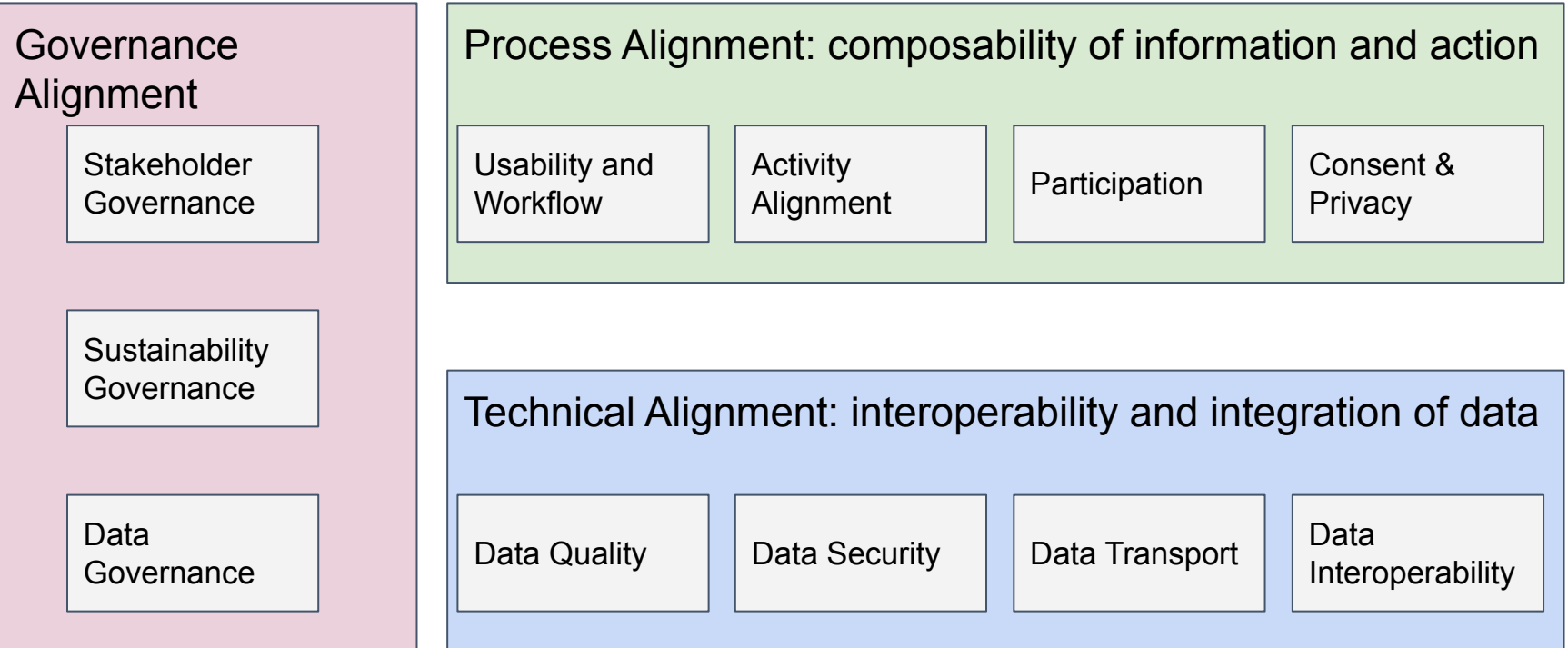
Level 4 - rules and structures for **operational data** management; data that records clinical, diagnostics, medication, workflow, and financial events

Level 5 - rules and structures for **knowledge data** management; digital knowledge sharing allows rapid update of the algorithms supporting clinical workflow or medication guidance

# Information flows / ehealth capabilities

- Clinical documentation sharing
- Diagnostic image sharing
- Laboratory orders and reports
- Insurance claims reimbursement
- Public health reporting
- Prescription to drug-drug-interaction decision support
- Appointment booking
- Rescue service to ambulance to ER
- Clinical trials hires/reports/monitoring
- Professionals registration
- Healthcare providers registration
- Home monitoring
- Self-triage to referral
- Video consultation
- Digital intervention apps

# Health Information Sharing Capability FW



# Health Information Sharing Maturity Assessment 2020

|            |                           | 1 Empowering | 2 Clinical | 3 Management | 4 Research | 5 Policy | 6 Funding |
|------------|---------------------------|--------------|------------|--------------|------------|----------|-----------|
| Technical  | 01 Data quality           | 2            | 2          | 2            | 3          | 2        | 3         |
|            | 02 Data transport         | 2            | 3          | 2            | 2          | 2        | 3         |
|            | 03 Data security          | 4            | 4          | 4            | 4          | 4        | 4         |
|            | 04 Interoperability       | 3            | 3          | 3            | 2          | 2        | 3         |
| Process    | 05 Usability              | 3            | 3          | 3            | 3          | 2        | 3         |
|            | 06 Alignment              | 2            | 3          | 3            | 3          | 2        | 2         |
|            | 07 Participation          | 4            | 3          | 4            | 3          | 3        | 2         |
|            | 08 Consent                | 3            | 3          | 3            | 3          | 2        | 2         |
| Governance | 09 Data governance        | 3            | 3          | 2            | 2          | 2        | 2         |
|            | 10 Stakeholder governance | 2            | 3          | 3            | 2          | 2        | 2         |
|            | 11 Sustainability         | 4            | 2          | 2            | 4          | 3        | 4         |

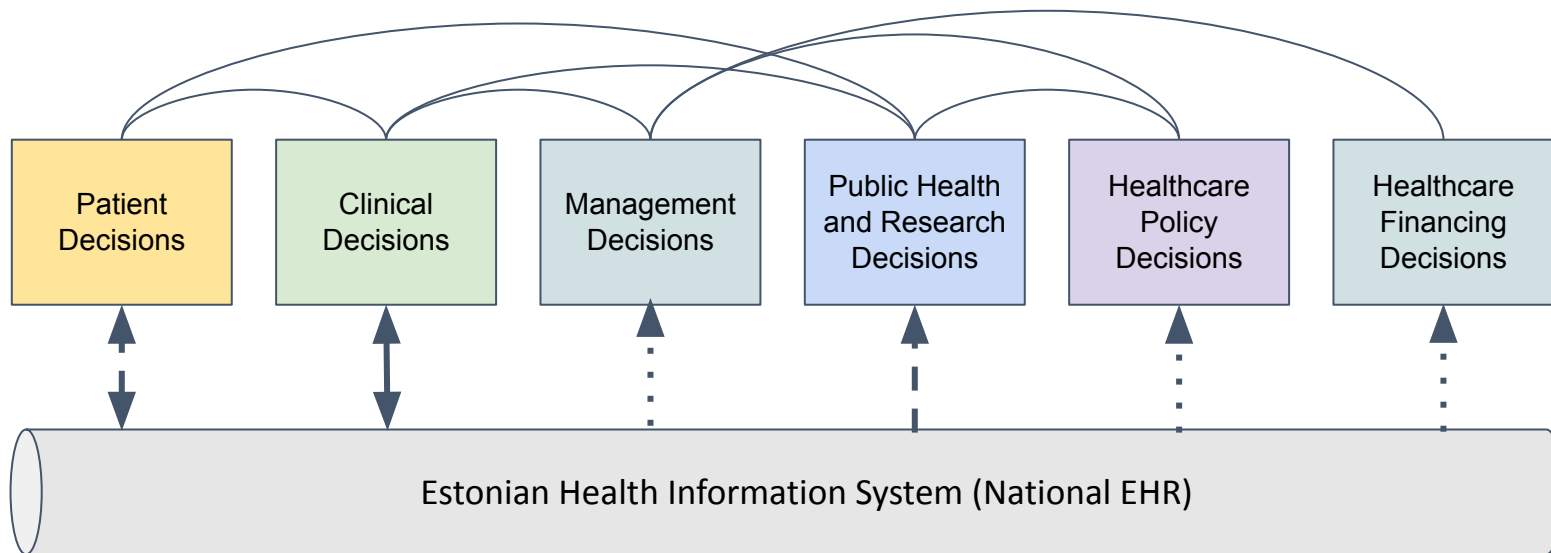
Improvement of the maturity

|             | Process characteristics | Technology characteristics | Governance characteristics |
|-------------|-------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| Optimizing  |                         |                            |                            |
| Performance | Participation           | Security                   |                            |
| Standards   | Consent<br>Usability    | Interoperability           | Sustainability             |
| Experts     | Alignment               | Transport<br>Quality       | Data<br>Stakeholder        |
| Projects    |                         |                            |                            |

Assessing specific capability: data and stakeholder purpose, data flow, and data sharing

# Findings: Still lots of point-to-point data exchange

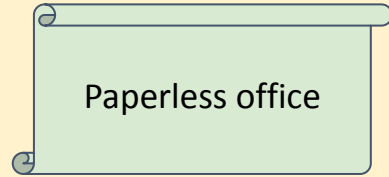
Often the existing model of data exchange requires manual re-capture because of the interoperability issues



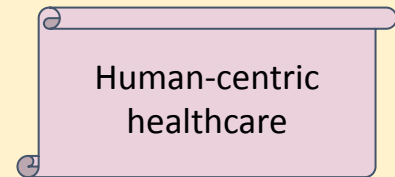


# Institutional logic: implementation is based on technology and culture

Idea:  
Intended  
Model



Transactional = Transactional



Transactional  $\neq$  Informational

Logic

Home

Clinic

Regulator

Insurance

IT

Science

Solution:  
Implemented  
Model

Digital Health **Standards**,  
Platform ja Applications

HIS

?

Registry

?

Data Viewer

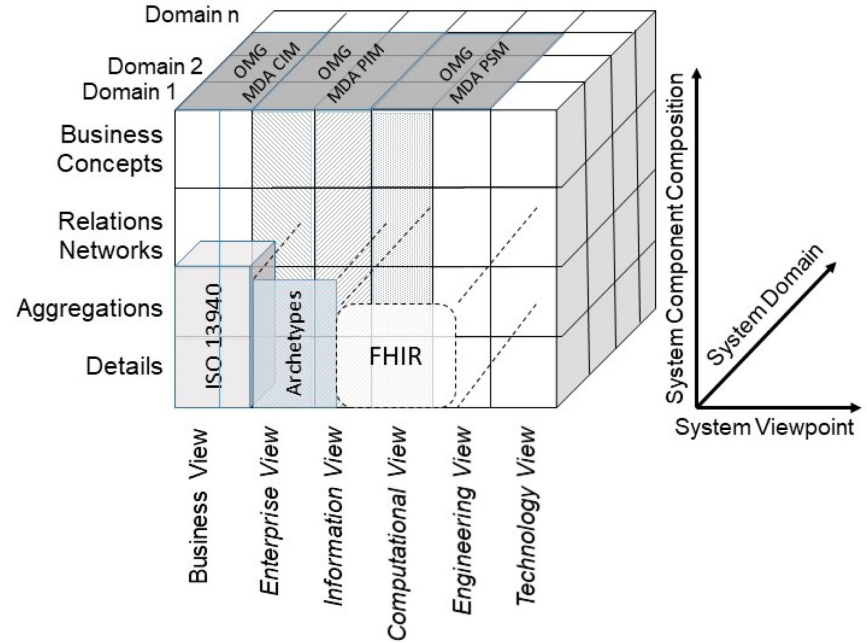
?

CDSS

# Making Sense of eHealth 3D - ISO 23903

ISO 23903 - Health informatics.  
Interoperability and integration reference  
architecture. Model and framework

- Viewpoint
  - Requirements, organization, tools, technology
- Components / Composition
  - Concepts, relations, details
- Domains
  - Capability, purpose, provision, custody, consumption



# Cartography exercise

Q Search page or heading...

- EHIS Doctor Portal
- EHIS e-ambulance
- EHIS Patient Portal
- EHIS\_Data\_Analytic\_services
- Ester 3
- Estonian Adverse Drug Reaction Database
- Estonian Business Register
- Estonian Cancer Screening Registry
- [Estonian Genome Center Database](#)
- Estonian Medicinal Products Registry
- Estonian open data
- Estonian PACS
- Estonian Register of Clinical Trials
- EVI 1
- EVI
- Geneto
- GLIMS
- Hammass
- Hansasoft
- Health Apps - MediReq

# Estonian Genome Database



estonian genome center  
university of tartu

### Description

The [Estonian Genome Center's](#) database (aka [EUGEN](#)) is a large collection of genetic data that contains genetic information from over 200,000 individuals in [Estonia](#), making it a valuable resource for genetic research. It is one of the largest biobanks

## History

The [Estonian Genome Center](#) was established in 2009 and is dedicated to the study of genomics and personalized medicine, based at the [University of Tartu](#) in Estonia and has been a leader in genomic research in the region.

### Scale of the Estonian Biobank

As of April 2024, **about 20% of Estonia's adult population's** genetic data are a part of the Estonian Biobank, which makes it a high-throughput, comprehensive genome database.

Through robust collection of genetic data, Estonian Biobank enables three main

Powered by Obsidian Publish

# Cartography - why, what, who, where

- **WHY** - propose a vision for one
  - Personal health journey
  - Medication and prescriptions
  - Sclerosis-multiplex research
  - Hospital network capacity
  - Lifestyle promotion
  - Health diagnostics

Austrian Health Data Space

Contextualize

**WHO**  
participates

**WHAT**  
decisions

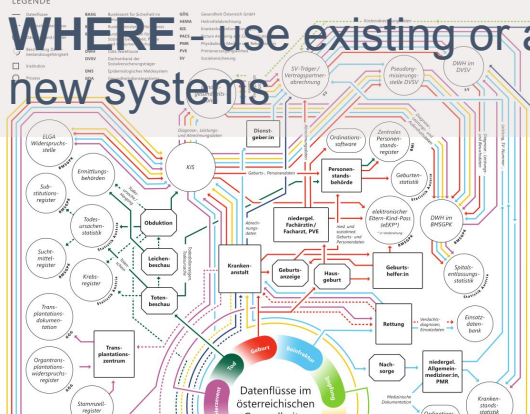
Map

**WHO**  
uses

**WHAT**  
data

LEGENDE

**WHERE** - use existing or add new systems



[https://goeg.at/EU\\_Gesundheitsdatenraum\\_EHDS](https://goeg.at/EU_Gesundheitsdatenraum_EHDS)



**[janek.metsallik@taltech.ee](mailto:janek.metsallik@taltech.ee)**

**School of IT**

**eMed Lab / Digital Health MSc programme**

**Tallinn University of Technology**